

DJING IN 2030.

IT'S NOT DYING. IT'S MOVING.

A field guide to where dance music is actually moving in the next five years — and the moves to make now.

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ONE HONEST NOTE

This is our reading of the data. Every trend and stat is real and sourced.
The interpretation — that DJing is migrating east — is editorial framing, not fact.
The trends are visible. The future they add up to is our best guess.
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SECTION 01

SEVEN TRENDS.

Not predictions. What's already measurable, right now, across the global dance music economy.

01 WESTERN CLUB CONTRACTION

Over 480 UK independent nightclubs have closed since 2020 — one-third of the pre-pandemic total. In the US, more than 12% of nightclubs shut down in the last two years alone.

Source: UK Night Time Industries Association 2025 · US industry closure reports

02 GEN Z DISENGAGEMENT

61% of UK 18-30 year olds report going out less than the year before. Only 16% regularly go out past 10 PM. The generation that would carry club culture forward isn't participating.

Source: Keep Hush Gen Z Nightlife Survey · NTIA 2025

03 DAYTIME AND SOBER EVENTS RISING

Sober-curious event attendance grew 92% year-over-year. Thermal and wellness events up over 1,000%. Vampire Weekend headlined a 1:30 PM set to 20,000 people.

Source: Eventbrite platform data, US metros, 2024-2025

04 STREAMING ECLIPSING PHYSICAL ATTENDANCE

Boiler Room reaches 283 million viewers per month across YouTube, Instagram and TikTok — most of whom will never step into a club. Viewership is the new attendance.

Source: Boiler Room / Billboard 2024 reporting

05 ASIA-PACIFIC AS THE FASTEST-GROWING EDM REGION

Asia-Pacific holds 22.8% of the global EDM market share in 2025, projected to grow at 11.3% CAGR through 2034 — the fastest of any region globally.

Source: EDM industry market reports 2025

06 MIDDLE EAST BUILDING FROM ZERO

Public concerts were virtually unknown in Saudi Arabia before 2017. MDLBEAST Soundstorm now draws 600,000 attendees over three days. Vision 2030 is state-funded festival infrastructure at scale.

Source: MDLBEAST 2023 attendance data · Saudi Vision 2030 reports

07 INDIA'S DEMOGRAPHIC WAVE

India: EDM festival attendance up 40%. 600 million Indians under 35 with 4G access and streaming apps. Ultra Music Festival launched Indian edition in 2025.

Source: IFPI India · industry festival attendance reports 2024-2025

SECTION 02

PUSH. PULL. COST.

The seven trends above have three underlying drivers. Understand these and you understand why the shift is structural, not cyclical.

PUSH · WHAT'S SHRINKING THE WEST

Rising club operating costs. Gen Z going out less and spending less when they do. The sober-curious cultural shift. Housing costs eating into disposable income. The audience for the classic late-night club is shrinking faster than it's being replaced. This isn't a bad quarter or a slow year — it's structural, and the closures reflect it.

PULL · WHAT'S GROWING THE EAST

Demographics: 600 million Indians under 35, with new smartphone and streaming access. State investment: Saudi Arabia's Vision 2030 is pouring public money into building an entertainment industry from scratch. Streaming access: China's EDM streaming grew 50% in two years. New middle-class audiences with disposable income and no historical alternative for public entertainment — that combination didn't exist ten years ago.

COST · THE MIDDLE VARIABLE

Lower operating costs in parts of Asia mean better margins for touring DJs. That explains why individual artists are increasingly booking east — the money is better. But cost alone doesn't explain why the scenes themselves are growing. That's demographics and investment. Cost is why DJs move. Demographics is why the audience arrives.

THE LINE THAT MATTERS

This isn't decline. It's redistribution.

The stage isn't going away. It's moving.

SECTION 03

THE FIVE MOVES.

What to do in the next 12 months to be ready for where the industry is going. Practical, not aspirational.

01 AUDIT YOUR CAREER GEOGRAPHY

Pull the last 20 gigs you played. Plot them on a mental map. If more than 80% are within a 200 km radius, you're playing the shrinking version of the market. The DJs who last through the next five years are the ones who tour outside their region — even occasionally.

02 BUILD ONE NON-LOCAL RELATIONSHIP THIS QUARTER

One agent, one promoter, or one peer DJ in a growth market — Dubai, Mumbai, Bangkok, Riyadh, Seoul. Not a booking. A relationship. Comment on their posts. DM them about their sets. Build trust before you need it. The DJs booked internationally in 2027 are having those conversations in 2025.

03 LEARN ONE NON-LOCAL SOUND

Study the tracks, producers, and mixing styles coming out of the market you're targeting. Not to imitate — to understand. A DJ who can read a Mumbai or Riyadh crowd through the music that shaped them is exponentially more bookable than one who arrives with a Western-only crate.

04 STUDY ONE ASIAN OR MIDDLE EAST VENUE'S RESIDENCY MODEL

How do they book? What do they pay? What's the season? What kind of set are they looking for? This information is public — venue websites, industry press, interviews with resident DJs. Twenty minutes of research on a specific venue teaches you more than a year of guessing.

05 REPOSITION YOUR BIO FOR GLOBAL BOOKINGS

Rewrite your bio to be location-agnostic and portfolio-forward. Lead with the sound, not the city. Make sure your press kit, mixes, and photos are one click from anywhere in the world. A promoter in Dubai making a Wednesday morning decision shouldn't have to hunt for your material.

SECTION 04 · THE AUDIT

WHAT'S CHANGING NEAR YOU?

Global trends only mean something when you can see them locally. Ten questions to spot the shift in your own city — before the industry press does.

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| 01 How many clubs you used to play at have closed in the last three years? | 02 Are the daytime events in your city growing, shrinking, or flat over the last two years? |
| 03 What percentage of touring DJs coming through your city are from outside the country? | 04 Have any Asian or Middle Eastern festival brands announced editions in your region recently? |
| 05 Where does your youngest audience (18-25) actually go out now — clubs, house parties, daytime events, at all? | 06 Are your local promoters booking more international acts or more locals in the last 12 months? |
| 07 Have any sober venues, wellness raves, or coffee parties launched in your city in the last two years? | 08 What was the last venue closure in your city? What replaced it, if anything? |
| 09 Are the club nights that survived running the same format they did five years ago, or have they evolved? | 10 If you asked your ten most-booked peers where their next tour is heading — how many would name an Asian or Middle Eastern city? |

HOW TO USE THIS

Answer these honestly. Do it once now, then again in six months. If more than three answers changed, the shift is already visible in your city. If they didn't — check again in a year. The DJs who see the pattern first are the ones who move first.

THE AUDIT

Screenshot this page. Answer the questions honestly. Come back in six months and compare. Your local answers are more reliable than any global trend report.

SECTION 05

GO DEEPER.

The industry reports, journalists, and voices worth tracking as all of this unfolds.

INDUSTRY REPORTS

THE PRIMARY DATA

- **UK Night Time Industries Association (NTIA)**
Annual reports on UK nightlife economy. The definitive source on club closures. ntia.co.uk
- **International Music Summit (IMS) Business Report**
The industry's most respected annual dance-music state-of-the-industry report. internationalmusicsummit.com
- **Eventbrite Trend Reports**
Platform-level data on daytime events, sober raves, wellness gatherings. eventbrite.com/blog
- **IFPI Global Music Report**
Recording industry data by region — the best source for streaming and regional-market shifts.

JOURNALISM WORTH TRACKING

STAY CURRENT

- **Resident Advisor**
Best long-form coverage of the electronic music industry globally. ra.co
- **Mixmag**
Consistent reporting on club closures, festival launches, and Gen Z nightlife shifts. mixmag.net
- **DJ Mag**
Global DJ economy coverage. Their Top 100 is a marketing exercise; the journalism is genuinely good.
- **Music Business Worldwide**
Industry-side reporting on streaming, licensing, and where the money actually flows. musicbusinessworldwide.com

THE STAGE ISN'T GOING AWAY. IT'S MOVING. READ THE MAP EARLY.

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- No.05 — Protect Your Ears. (hearing toolkit)
- No.06 — Your Brain On DJing. (neuroscience field guide)
- No.07 — You're Paid To Put People Back Inside Their Own Memories.
- No.08 — The Machine Can Mix Now. (AI-proof playbook)

OUR READING OF THE DATA

The trends are real and sourced. The interpretation is editorial. Reasonable people can read the same data differently.